



YOU ARE **15 WEEKS 2 DAYS**

173 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

The fingertips are prominent and the fingers still quite short. Each finger is separate and moves independently of the rest. This is the most comfortable position for the hand, with the thumb and fingers outstretched rather than curled into a fist.

“You’re unlikely to feel any movements yet, but your baby is becoming increasingly active inside your uterus.”

By now, your baby may be active for up to five minutes at a time. In the next few weeks, you may begin to feel some slight fluttering movements, particularly if this is not your first pregnancy (see [Noticing first movements](#)). You’ll only be aware of those movements that cause your baby to make contact with the inner muscular wall of your uterus.

The placenta can act like a cushion absorbing the impact of all but the strongest of the baby’s movements. This is why women with an anterior placenta (one lying on the front wall of the uterus, closest to the skin) often feel movements at a later stage than those with a posteriorly sited one (that lies closer to the back). Your baby’s brain is continuing to develop. The nerve cells that will form the outer gray matter start centrally within the brain, and need to move outward to their final position. This process takes place in waves that occur from 8 to 16 weeks. The migration process is not complete until 25 weeks and electrical activity cannot be detected until 29 weeks. Even after this point, gray matter continues to mature and organize neural connections in the brain throughout the pregnancy. Your baby’s body is now longer than her head for the first time.